Ronny Badilla

Senior Site Reliability Engineer · AWS · Kubernetes · observability · incident response

San José, Costa Rica (UTC-6, full US workday overlap) · info@ronnybadilla.com
github.com/rbadillap · linkedin.com/in/rbadillap

SUMMARY

Senior site reliability engineer with nearly 20 years of experience across software, cloud infrastructure, DevOps, and observability. Most recently at TransUnion, where I operated Kubernetes clusters with GitOps, served in the on-call rotation, and built agent-driven self-healing that brought Kubernetes alert volume to a very low level.

I automate operational work first: self-healing, incident triage and escalation, release gates, and infrastructure as code. That automation led to an additional role bringing AI agents into production at TransUnion. I have more than 15 years of experience working directly with English-speaking clients, engineering leaders, and cross-functional stakeholders.

EXPERIENCE

TransUnion, Senior Site Reliability Engineer — 2023 – 2026

- Built self-healing for Kubernetes workloads as part of a dedicated team: when pods degraded, an agent correlated the last deployment, health checks, logs, saturation, and dependency health, then restarted the unhealthy replica, scaled the replica count, drained the node, or escalated to a person.
- Kubernetes alert volume fell to a very low level, and the result earned the team additional budget for AI work.
- Operated Kubernetes clusters across regions and environments (about five per region and environment, some in separate AWS accounts) with GitOps on ArgoCD; ran blue-green cluster upgrades in night-time deployment windows and brought application teams into the practice.
- Served in the on-call rotation, with first-line support for internal users and second- and third-line support for external users, on Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, and New Relic.
- Wrote internal Terraform modules with the Platform Engineering team: primitives (VPC, EC2, load balancers) and pattern-based abstractions (websites, VPC connections, SSL certificates, domains).
- Investigated incidents from failed changes (Kubernetes, application upgrades, Terraform, configuration), and kept a daily operational wiki that the planner agent read to propose new self-healing actions.
- Built delivery controls invoked from CI/CD that evaluated each deployment against its team's versioned playbook and stopped it before execution when it did not comply; workflows paused for an authorized decision in Slack or GitHub Actions and resumed safely.
- Took on an additional product engineering role bringing AI into the company: semantic search on OpenSearch, an analytics agent in Microsoft Teams, and an agentic status page, in internal production use across five geographic regions.

SynerOps, Founder 2021 – 2024

- Built an incident workflow for FedRAMP-related compliance with a one-hour notification requirement: GuardDuty, Security Hub, Inspector, and Config events on EventBridge started Step Functions triage and evidence collection, opened ServiceNow tickets through an SQS buffer, and escalated through an SNS-driven path (SMS, voice, HTTP) to a second response group and the on-call team as each time threshold passed.
- Built an internal observability and compliance platform for estates of thousands of heterogeneous microservices, centralizing logs, metrics, and AWS Cost and Usage Reports in S3 with Glue, Parquet, and Kinesis Data Firehose while preserving each team's local toolchain; built Prometheus exporters and adapters for tools without a suitable output.
- Worked across a hybrid Kubernetes platform of approximately 300 microservices for a multilateral development bank: GitLab CI/CD with ArgoCD and Helm, KEDA event-driven scaling across chained queue stages, Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki, container image scanning, and AWS to Google Cloud connectivity over VPN and Direct Connect.

Syner, Founder 2025 – Present

- Published dot, an open-source CLI in POSIX shell that manages a Mac as code with a check and apply workflow, comparable to plan and apply in Terraform.
- Published ai-gateways-benchmark, an open-source, zero-dependency tool that measures AI gateway latency phase by phase (connection setup, TTFB, and TTFT, cold and warm), with percentile reporting and reliability as a first-class result.

Automattic, Infrastructure Engineer, Openverse (contractor) 2023 (11 months)

- Designed and built the AWS environment for the open-source media search engine and completed its migration from local infrastructure to production within the engagement.
- Operated Airflow crawling and indexing pipelines on ECS, SQS, SNS, and S3; implemented blue-green CI/CD deployments for the public portal and branch-isolated previews across code, workflows, environments, data snapshots, catalogs, and image repositories.

SoftwareONE, Solutions Architect 2018 – 2022

- Led enterprise discovery, architecture, hands-on implementation, operating-model documentation, and engineer training while SoftwareONE established its AWS consulting capability.

SKILLS

Reliability and operations: On-call operations, self-healing, incident triage and escalation, operational playbooks, deployment gates, and blue-green upgrades and delivery.

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, New Relic, Loki, OpenSearch, logs, metrics, alerts, exporters, and cost evidence from AWS Cost and Usage Reports.

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS, ECS/EKS, S3, EventBridge, Step Functions, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Redis, Glue, Kinesis, Terraform modules, VPN, and Direct Connect.

Kubernetes and delivery: Kubernetes, GitOps with ArgoCD, Helm, KEDA, Docker, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, container image scanning, and preview environments.

Security and compliance: Policy as code with Cloud Custodian, RBAC, OAuth/OIDC, human approval workflows, FedRAMP-related, SOC 2, and GDPR requirements.

Languages and automation: Python, TypeScript/Node.js, Go, Bash and POSIX shell, SQL, REST, OpenAPI, webhooks, durable workflows, and agent-assisted operations.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

DNAMIC, Technical Lead, Arena Edge 2015 – 2017

Early career, Software engineering across agencies and staff augmentation 2007 – 2015